

231 Take a bark rubbing

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MINS

Different trees have different types of bark. Some are smooth, some are rough, and some are in between, but all protect trees from injury and disease. Take rubbings to compare the bark of trees in your yard.

What you need

- Crayons
- Thick drawing paper
- Tape
- Field guide to trees (optional)



1 Choose a tree and brush off any loose particles from its bark. Tape a piece of paper to the tree trunk.



2 Rub the paper with the side of the crayon. This will show any unique notches, ridges, and other patterns in the bark.

Bark patterns

3 Remove the rubbing carefully from the trunk. Use a guide to identify the tree and write down its name, bark type, and color.

Crayons



232 Count tree rings

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Find a tree's age by counting its growth rings—the light and dark circles shown in a cross-section of a trunk. One light plus one dark ring equals one full year of growth.

Light wood shows spring growth

